

k.c) Briefly explain theories of Origin of Languages. (15 marks)

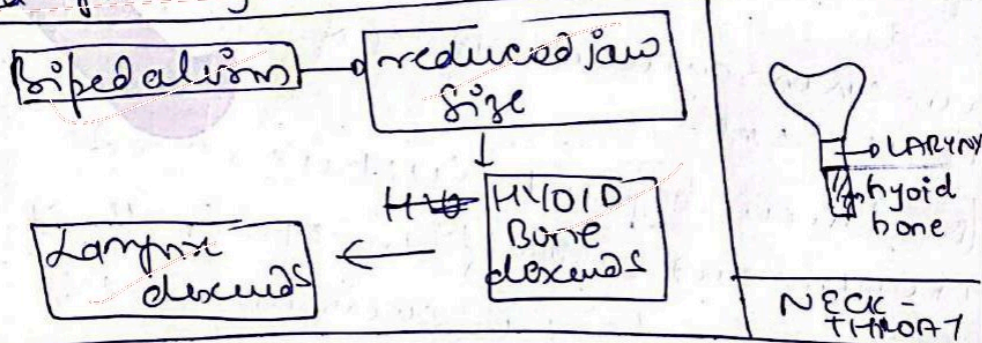
Edward Sapir stated that language is a human and ~~not~~ deliberate way of communicated ideas, desires and patterns in voluntary manner.

Origin of Language



Biological Theories :-

① Laryngeal Descent : It states that as we became bipedal, the hyoid bone descended and created space for the larynx to grow. This allowed sounds.



②

② Noam Chomsky's Universal Grammar :- He says we all have a "Linguistic Acquisition Device" (LAD) that has a natural propensity to learn languages.

③ Swaente Laabø and Fox P2 :- He stated that Fox P2 mutation is found in echolocation mammals. This mutation may have allowed sounds.

Cultural THEORIES :-

Criticism of Biological Theories :-

- do not explain diversity of languages
- discount role of culture

① Divine Theory :- Every culture has a myth that its gods created language. Yahweh, god in Central Asia created tongue to confuse the people (Judaism)

② Imitation Theories :- we imitated :-

<u>DING DONG</u> (Max Müller)	<u>Poo Poo</u>	<u>Bow</u> <u>WOW</u>	<u>TATA</u> (Paget)	<u>SING</u> <u>SONG</u>
vibrations & natural reverberations	Pain & emotion sounds	(dogs, beasts)	(action of hand to say bye)	(Isperson)

③ Needs Theory :-

3.1) Yo He ho : Theory ^{that} ~~have~~ ritualistic and communal labour to required ritualistic and coherent shouting

3.2) Theory of mind / Linguistic Theory :- EH

Sturtevant said that to create lies (once we understood scenarios) we needed language.

3.3) Warning Hypothesis :- Related to gesture calls, the need to call out in emergencies, in darks over walls led to language.

④ Noy Rapoport says a combination of all led to language

① Criticism :- Language is a part of culture and thus may have a BIO CULTURAL origin as seen in studies of primatology, Child development

② LINGUISTIC DETERMINISM states that language is beginning of all thought.

Recently, a new "Put the baby down" theory states that as babies could not cling to fur of mother every time it was put down, it cries created language